

Nicole Mitidieri-Rivera
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<https://phyloverse.github.io/>

EDUCATION

Ph.D., Botany Department, University of Wisconsin-Madison, Madison, WI	2026
Dissertation: <i>Evolutionary pathways to becoming a fig: a phylogenetic comparative approach</i> .	
Faculty mentor: Kenneth J. Sytsma.	
Committee: Kenneth M. Cameron, Ken Keefover-Ring, Claudia Solís-Lemus, Elliot M. Gardner, Leandro Cardoso Pederneiras	
MSc., Botany Department, University of Wisconsin-Madison, Madison, WI	2024
Certificate in Botanical Illustration, with distinction, Royal Botanic Garden Edinburgh	2024
MSc. Tropical Botany, Universidad Nacional Mayor de San Marcos	2019
B.Sc. Biological Sciences, Universidad Nacional de la Amazonía Peruana	2016

MANUSCRIPTS

30. **Mitidieri-Rivera, N.**, Wajer, J., Pederneiras, L. (2026). (3133-3134) Proposals to reject the names *Ficus serrata* and *F. maculata* (Moraceae). *Taxon* 75(1): e70112. DOI: <https://doi.org/10.1002/tax.70112>
29. **Mitidieri-Rivera, N.**, Damián-Parizaca, A., Gardner, E., Pederneiras, L. (2026). A nomenclator of *F. sect. Americanae* (Moraceae). Part II: North and Central America, and the Antilles. *Phytotaxa* 739(2):145–182. DOI: <https://doi.org/10.11646/phytotaxa.739.2.3>
28. **Mitidieri-Rivera, N.**, Wajer, J., Pederneiras, L. (2025). (3127) Proposal to reject the name *Ficus calyculata* (Moraceae). *Taxon* 74(6): 1584–1585. DOI: <https://doi.org/10.1002/tax.70084>
27. **Mitidieri-Rivera, N.**, Damián-Parizaca, A., Gardner, E., Plata-Castro, A., Zerega, N., Pederneiras, L. (2025). A nomenclator of *F. sect. Americanae* (Moraceae). Part I: South America. *Phytotaxa* 711(3): 215–262. DOI: <https://doi.org/10.11646/phytotaxa.711.3.1>
26. **Mitidieri-Rivera, N.**, Damián-Parizaca, A. (2025). *Ficus sytsmae* (Moraceae), a new species from South America and the reinstatement of *Ficus schiedeana*. *Phytotaxa* 708(2): 167–181. DOI: <https://doi.org/10.11646/phytotaxa.708.2.4>
25. **Mitidieri-Rivera, N.**, Gardner, E., Phipps, J., Zerega, N., Pederneiras, L., Damián-Parizaca, A., Sytsma, K. (2025). How to be a big genus? *Ficus* L. as an emerging model. *Annals of Botany* 00: 1–27. DOI: <https://doi.org/10.1093/aob/mcaf101>

24. **Mitidieri-Rivera, N.**, Pederneiras, L.C., Parizaca, A.D., & Castillo, J.A. (2020). A new species and a new record of *Ficus* sect. *Pharmacosycea* (Moraceae) from Peru. *Systematic Botany* 45(1): 91–95. DOI: <https://doi.org/10.1600/036364420X15801369352342>
23. Pederneiras, L.C., Plata-Castro, A.D. & **Mitidieri-Rivera, N.** (2026). New species of *Ficus* sect. *Pharmacosycea* (Moraceae) from the Andes and Coastal regions of Ecuador. *Phytotaxa* 747(1):131-138. DOI: <https://doi.org/10.11646/phytotaxa.747.1.9>
22. Plata-Castro, A.D., Díaz-Rueda, D.M., **Mitidieri-Rivera, N.**, Mansano, V., Pederneiras, L. (2025). Typification of *Ficus* L. (Moraceae) names published by the Colombian botanist Armando Dugand, and a new record for Colombian Flora. *Phytotaxa* 734(2): 191-206. DOI: <https://doi.org/10.11646/phytotaxa.734.2.4>
21. Damián-Parizaca, A., Karremans, A.P., Barona-Colmenares, A.A., Iturralde, G., Pérez, A.J., de la Cruz, W., Jost, L., Garzón, H.X., Villalba-Vargas, D., Zenteno-Ruiz, F.S., Moya-Huanca, A.L., Castro, C., Pizango, J., Vilcatoma, E., Bentley, A.G., Jiménez, M.M., Baquero, L., **Mitidieri-Rivera, N.**, Cameron, K.M. (2025). The Genus *Vanilla* (Orchidaceae) in South America—Bolivia, Colombia, Ecuador, and Peru: An Annotated Checklist with a New Species. *Annals of the Missouri Botanical Garden* 110, 335–362. DOI: <https://doi.org/10.3417/2025992>
20. Damián-Parizaca, A., Karremans, A.P., **Mitidieri-Rivera, N.**, Cameron, K.M. (2025). Towards a monograph of membranaceous Vanillas: a nomenclatural revision of *Vanilla* subgen. *Vanilla* (Vanilloideae, Orchidaceae). *Plant Ecology & Evolution* 158(1), 111–121. DOI: <https://doi.org/10.5091/plecevo.140667>
19. Damián-Parizaca, A., Monteros, M.F., Coayla-Rimachi, D., Walston, J., **Mitidieri-Rivera, N.** (2025). A new species of *Pleurothallis* (Pleurothallidinae, Orchidaceae) from the historic sanctuary of Machupicchu, Perú. *PhytoKeys* 254, 29. DOI: <https://doi.org/10.3897/phytokeys.254.142116>
18. Pederneiras, L. C., Zamengo, H. B., Zapata-C, D. A., **Mitidieri-Rivera, N.**, Romaniuc-Neto, S., & Mansano, V. D. F. (2023). *Ficus* subgen. *Spherosuke* sect. *Americanae* ser. *Dugandii* (Moraceae): A Curved Ostiolar Margin Group of Neotropical Fig Trees. *Systematic Botany* 48(2): 263–282. DOI: <https://doi.org/10.1600/036364423X16847773873215>
17. Damián-Parizaca, A., & **Mitidieri-Rivera, N.** (2023). *Vanilla cameroniana* (Orchidaceae, Vanilloideae), a new species from French Guiana and new records from the Guiana Shield. *Phytotaxa* 609(3), 222–232. DOI: <https://doi.org/10.11646/phytotaxa.609.3.5>
16. Damián-Parizaca, A., Garzon, H.X., Baquero, L., Jimenez, M.M., Velez-Abarca, L., Iturralde, G.A., **Mitidieri-Rivera, N.**, Olortegui, S., Cameron, K.M. (2022). *Vanilla andina* (Vanilloideae, Orchidaceae), a new species of the membranaceous-leaved group from Peru and Ecuador. *Phytotaxa* 552 (1), 63–72. DOI: <https://doi.org/10.11646/phytotaxa.552.1.5>
15. Damián-Parizaca, A., Hagsater, E., **Mitidieri-Rivera, N.** (2022). A new Peruvian species of *Epidendrum* (Laeliinae: Orchidaceae) belonging to the *Epidendrum incomptum* group. *Phytotaxa* 552(1), 099–106. DOI: <https://doi.org/10.11646/phytotaxa.552.1.9>
14. Damián-Parizaca, A., **Mitidieri-Rivera, N.**, Bonilla, M., Huayllani, J.T. (2021). A new species, lectotypification and new records in *Catasetum* (Orchidaceae: Catasetinae) from Peruvian Amazon. *Botany Letters* 168(2), 191–199. DOI: <https://doi.org/10.1080/23818107.2020.1871404>
13. Damián-Parizaca, A., **Mitidieri-Rivera, N.**, Rimarachin, L. (2021). A new species of *Opilionanthe* (Pleurothallidinae, Orchidaceae) and new records in the *Lepanthes* clade for Perú. *Nordic Journal of Botany* 39(9), 1–9. DOI: 10.1111/njb.03307

12. Damián-Parizaca, A., **Mitidieri-Rivera, N.**, Edquen, J. (2021). Taxonomic and nomenclatural notes on *Fernandezia* (Orchidaceae, Oncidiinae) from Peru. *Ann. Bot. Fennici* 58, 245–251. DOI: <https://doi.org/10.5735/085.058.0409>
11. Pederneiras, L., **Mitidieri-Rivera, N.**, Romaniuc-Neto, S., Manzano, V. (2021). Typification of *Ficus* sect. *Americanae* (Moraceae): Typification of *F. aurea* and *F. pertusa* complexes. *Phytotaxa* 514(2): 149–157. DOI: <https://doi.org/10.11646/phytotaxa.514.2.6>
10. Damián-Parizaca, A. & **Mitidieri-Rivera, N.** (2020). Living in the clouds: A new high-elevation species of *Vanilla* (Orchidaceae, Vanilloideae) from Perú. *Phytotaxa* 451(2), 154–160. DOI: <https://doi.org/10.11646/phytotaxa.451.2.5>
9. Damián-Parizaca, A., Salazar, G.A., **Mitidieri-Rivera, N.**, Altamirano, S. (2020). A new species and first record of the genus *Solenocentrum* (Orchidaceae: Cranichidinae) from Peru. *Lankesteriana* 20(3), 339–344. DOI: <http://dx.doi.org/10.15517/lank.v20i3.45012>
8. Damián-Parizaca, A., **Mitidieri-Rivera, N.**, Ormerod, P. (2020). *Crossoglossa puipuiensis* (Malaxideae: Orchidaceae), a new species, and new records of *Crossoglossa* from Peru. *Annales Botanici Fennici* 58(1-3), 37–43. DOI: <https://doi.org/10.5735/085.058.0107>
7. Pederneiras, L., Monge, C., **Mitidieri-Rivera, N.**, et al. (2020). Nomenclatural revision of *Ficus* sect. *Americanae* (Moraceae): Typification of *F. citrifolia* and allied species. *Phytotaxa* 474(2): 145–153. DOI: <https://doi.org/10.11646/phytotaxa.474.2.4>
6. Pederneiras, L., da Costa, A., Medeiros, H., **Mitidieri-Rivera, N.**, et al. (2020). Species diversity of *Ficus* L. sect. *Americanae* (Moraceae) in Acre, Brazil. *Brittonia* 72: 215–231. DOI: <https://doi.org/10.1007/s12228-020-09620-1>
5. Pederneiras, L., Monge, C., **Mitidieri-Rivera, N.**, et al. (2019). Nomenclatural revision of *Ficus* sect. *Americanae* (Moraceae): Typification of *Ficus crocata* and allied species. *Phytotaxa* 414(5): 262–268. DOI: <https://doi.org/10.11646/phytotaxa.474.2.4>
4. Damián-Parizaca, A., **Mitidieri-Rivera, N.**, Chiron, G. (2018). A taxonomic synopsis of *Acianthera* (Orchidaceae Pleurothallidinae) in Peru, including two new species. *Anales del Jardín Botánico de Madrid* 75(1), 5. DOI: <https://doi.org/10.3989/ajbm.2449>

SUBMITTED AND PRE-PRINTS

3. **Mitidieri-Rivera, N.**, Pederneiras, L., Gardner, E., Damián-Parizaca, A., Sytsma, K. A high-throughput phylogenomic framework for Neotropical fig stranglers (Moraceae). In preparation for *Taxon*
2. Pederneiras, L.C., Gardner, E.M., Plata-Castro, A., Hahn M., **Mitidieri-Rivera, N.**, et al. Phylogenomics Resolves Taxonomy and Reveals Hidden Diversity in Neotropical *Ficus* sect. *Pharmacosycea* (Moraceae). In review at *American Journal of Botany*
1. Damián-Parizaca, A., Pérez-Escobar, O., Karremans, A.P., Antonelli, A., Janovec J.P., **Mitidieri-Rivera, N.**, et al. Disentangling the Vine: Phylogenomics and Historical Biogeography of *Vanilla* (Orchidaceae). *bioRxiv* 2026.04.07.716943; doi: <https://doi.org/10.64898/2026.04.07.716943>

BOOKS

Peru's Ministry of Environment (2022) Reference level of forest emissions from gross deforestation in the Peruvian Amazon biome [PDF]. https://redd.unfccc.int/files/nref_peru_281122_final__2_.pdf

HERBARIUM CURATION

Herrerense Herbarium (HH) — Curator of Vascular Plants

2016

Herbaria Visited

U.S.A.: New York Botanical Garden (NY), Missouri Botanical Garden (MO), US National Herbarium (US), Field Museum Herbarium (F), Wisconsin State Herbarium (WIS)

Latin America: San Marcos Herbarium (USM), Universidad Nacional Agraria La Molina Herbarium (MOLF), Vargas Herbarium (CUZ), Truxillense Herbarium (HUT), Amazonense Herbarium (AMAZ), Herreense Herbarium (HH), Selva Central Oxapampa Herbarium (HOXA), Herbarium of the Botanical Garden of Rio de Janeiro (RB), Herbario Nacional (MEXU), National Herbarium of Costa Rica (CR)

Europe: Real Jardín Botánico de Madrid Vascular Plant Herbarium (MA), Kew Herbarium (K), Herbarium Berolinense (B), Natural History Museum Vienna Herbarium (W), Herbarium of the Muséum national d'Histoire Naturelle (P)

Curatorial Activities

Field research and specimen acquisition
 Specimen identification
 Voucher annotation
 Specimen cataloging
 Preparation of molecular voucher collections
 Collection and export authorization management
 Coordination of inter-institutional sample exchange agreements across herbaria

ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

University of Wisconsin-Madison, WI, USA

BOT 152: Introductory Biology Spring 2022, 2026

Teaching Assistant for Drs. Simon Gilroy, David Baum, and Jonathan Pauli

BOT 410: Evolution Summer 2025

Teaching Assistant for Dr. Brandon Corder

BOT 130: General Botany Fall-Spring 2023, Spring 2025

Teaching Assistant for Drs. David Baum, Kate McCulloh & Hiroshi Maeda

BOT 400: Plant Systematics Fall 2023, 2024

Teaching Assistant for Dr. Kenneth Sytsma

International Baccalaureate (IB) Program, Lima, Peru

2017-2019

Environmental Systems and Societies, Biology

Lead instructor for the IB Program and Middle School

Field Techniques and Tropical Ecology at the Cocha Cashu Biological Field Station, Perú 2014
Intro to Botany
Lead instructor

SUPPLEMENTARY TRAINNING

Phylogenetic Comparative Methods in R 2023
University of Massachusetts Boston (UMass Boston)
Instructors: Liam Revell & Luke Harmon

Internship in Molecular Biology, Biogeography, and Plant Systematics 2019
Instituto de Pesquisas Jardim Botânico do Rio de Janeiro (JBRJ)
Instructor: Leandro Cardoso Pederneiras

Tropical Plant Systematics, Costa Rica 2016
Organization for Tropical Studies (OTS)
Instructors: Robbin C. Moran, Amanda Grusz, Mauricio Bonifacino

Field Techniques and Tropical Ecology at the Cocha Cashu Biological Field Station, Perú 2013
San Diego Zoo Global (SDZG)
Instructors: John Terborgh, Mark Bowler, James Shepard & Harald Beck

RESEARCH GRANTS AND OTHER FUNDING (103,400 USD)

1. José Cuatrecasas Fellowship Award (**6,000 USD**). Botany, the Smithsonian Institution 2026
2. J. Croxdale and H. Iltis Research Fellowship (**20,000 USD**). Botany, UW-Madison 2025
3. Student Research Travel Funds (**1,500 USD**). WiSh Hub, UW-Madison 2025
4. LACIS Graduate Student Travel Grant (**1,200 USD**). LACIS, UW-Madison 2024
5. NYBG Visiting Scientist Travel Award (**1,400 USD**). NYBG Steere Herbarium 2024
6. Graduate Research Grant (**3,000 USD**). Society of Systematic Biologists 2023
7. P.E.O. International Peace Scholarship awardee (**20,000 USD**) 2022-2025
8. Graduate Research Awards (**10,000 USD**). Botany, UW-Madison 2022-2025
9. J. Croxdale Summer fellowship (**10,000 USD**). Botany, UW-Madison 2022-2023
10. Outstanding Young Conservationist (**1,500 USD**), Carlos Ponce Award 2022
11. Graduate Research Grant (**1,200 USD**). American Society of Plant Taxonomists 2022
12. Graduate Student Research Award (**1,500 USD**). Botanical Society of America 2022
13. Fulbright graduate fellowship (**20,000 USD**). Fulbright Perú 2021-2023
14. Travel Grant (**2,100 USD**), Concytec, Peru 2019
15. Travel Grant (**2,000 USD**), Concytec, Peru 2016
16. Partial Scholarship, Tropical Plant Systematics course (**2,000 USD**). OTS, Costa Rica 2016

RESEARCH

INKA TERRA ASOCIACIÓN

September 2024 – Ongoing

Associate Researcher

- Design and conduct biodiversity surveys, analyze ecological datasets, and contribute to the identification of conservation priorities for threatened species and habitats in the Peruvian Amazon.
- Support grant applications by synthesizing scientific literature, analyzing biodiversity data, and preparing technical content for funding proposals.
- Prepare technical reports and research summaries to communicate project outcomes and conservation impacts to donors and partners.

FAO, Lima, Peru

Carbon specialist

July 2020-2021

- Designed and implemented methodologies for carbon stock assessment to support Peru's Forest Reference Emission Level (FREL) under REDD+ framework guidelines.
- Led the technical evaluation and reporting of national forest carbon stocks, contributing to Peru's greenhouse gas inventory and climate change mitigation commitments.
- Collaborated with interdisciplinary teams to ensure data quality, methodological consistency, and compliance with international carbon accounting standards.

IIAP, Iquitos, Peru

Researcher and Herbarium manager

2016

- Conducted fieldwork and data analysis on carbon stocks in agroforestry systems across the Maynas and Requena provinces.
- Managed the Jenaro Herrera Research Center and coordinated ongoing research activities.
- Directed the Herrerense Herbarium in Jenaro Herrera, overseeing specimen collection, curation, and documentation.

CIFOR, Iquitos, Peru

Field Assistant

2015

- Collected and processed soil samples for carbon stock quantification in both natural forest and oil palm plantation systems in the Ucayali region of Peru.
- Assisted in establishing field plots and maintaining sampling protocols to ensure consistency and comparability across sites.

Research Assistant

2013-2015

- Conducted soil carbon stock monitoring in lowland peatlands dominated by *Mauritia flexuosa* (Arecaceae), contributing to long-term assessments of tropical peatland carbon dynamics.
- Collected and analyzed CO₂ and CH₄ gas samples from soils on a monthly basis to quantify greenhouse gas fluxes and inform ecosystem carbon balance models.
- Supported data management, field logistics, and calibration of equipment for tropical peatland carbon research projects.

INF, Iquitos, Peru

Brigade team

2013

- Led field teams in Amazonian lowland rainforests conducting vegetation surveys and plant collections for the National Forest Inventory.
- Collected and identified vascular plants, managed field logistics, and coordinated with local communities and herbaria.

University of Missouri–St. Louis & Missouri Botanical Garden, U.S.A.

Research Assistant

2012–2013

- Assessed aboveground biomass carbon storage and floristic composition in Peruvian Amazon peatlands.
- Established and inventoried 24 permanent 0.5-ha swamp forest plots in Loreto, Peru.

CONFERENCE AND INFORMAL TALKS

B130 Honors series talk

Madison, WI, November 2025

Botany Informal Talks (BITS)

Madison, WI, October 2025

Botany conference

Palm Springs, CA, July 2025

XX International Botanical Congress

Madrid, Spain, July 2024

Botany conference

Anchorage, AK, July 2022

Botany conference

Virtual, July 2021

AGU Fall Meeting

Virtual, December 2020

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Journal peer-review

Taxon

Kew Bulletin

Novon

Systematic Botany

Phytotaxa

Committees

Reviewer ASPT Graduate Student Grants

Present

Reviewer The LinnéSys: Systematics Research Fund

Present

American Society of Plant Taxonomists Publications Relations Committee

Present

Botany Department, UW-Madison,

Student member of the faculty and staff search committee.

2024-2025

Student member of the DEI, awards, social, and colloquium committees.

2022-2026

OUTREACH

- REACH Ambassador (UW-Madison) 2025-2026
Served as a representative for international scholars, fostering cross-cultural engagement and promoting inclusive academic and professional development across campus.
- International Student Services Advisory Board member (UW-Madison) 2025-2026
Advised on institutional policies and initiatives to enhance the academic experience and well-being of international students.
- Botanical Society of America Spotlight series 2025
- Certified Data Carpentries Instructor (R lessons) 2023-present
Taught foundational programming and data management skills to researchers in the life sciences, promoting open, reproducible, and inclusive computational practices.
- Webinars and public outreach (organizer and/or *presenter). YouTube: @Biologuía
- Vanilla Perú* | Public webinar on the taxonomy, ecology, and conservation of *Vanilla* species in Peru.
- Mujeres Botánicas* | Panel highlighting the contributions of women in botany and biodiversity research.
- Simposio de Orquídeas y Biodiversidad en Perú* | Organized symposium exploring orchid systematics and conservation in tropical ecosystems.
- Un abrazo que mata o da vida? El caso del género Ficus* | *Public lecture on ecological interactions and evolutionary strategies in *Ficus*.
- Botánica en tiempos del COVID* | Virtual outreach event discussing challenges and adaptations in botanical research during the pandemic.
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PROFESSIONAL SOCIETY MEMBERSHIP

American Society of Plant Taxonomists (ASPT)
Botanical Society of America (BSA)
International Association for Plant Taxonomy (IAPT)
Society of Systematic Biologists (SSB)

LANGUAGES

Native Spanish, fluent English, intermediate Italian, basic French and German.

REFERENCES

Kenneth J. Sytsma

Department of Botany

University of Wisconsin-Madison

kjsytsma@wisc.edu

Relationship: Ph.D. advisor

Elliot M. Gardner

Department of Biology

Case Western Reserve University

elliot.gardner@case.edu

Relationship: Ph.D. committee member & Collaborator

Leandro Cardoso Pederneiras

Fluminense Federal University, Niterói

leandro.pederneiras@gmail.com

Relationship: Ph.D. committee member & Collaborator